Nox User Guide

Version 0.3.0 · October 2026

Nox is a Mac app that runs your AI coding agents (Claude Code and Codex) for you. You say what you want; Nox works out the project, lets one agent build and the other review, each in its own copy of your repo, and asks you before anything risky. When the work is done you decide: keep it on a branch, send it back with the reviewer's notes, or throw it away.

This guide shows every screen, how to use each function, and a short demo you can follow on a throwaway repo.

> **About the pictures.** Every screenshot in this guide is Nox's real window, taken by an automated test with demo projects (`demo-a`, `demo-b`, `nox-try`), simulated agents shown as Claude and Codex, a made-up user ("Alex") and a fixed clock (Thursday 15 October, 10:24). None of it is real work or a real person's Mac.

Contents

1. What Nox is
2. Install
3. The screens
4. How to…
5. Demo: your first task, step by step
6. How Nox keeps you safe
7. FAQ
8. Keyboard shortcuts

1. What Nox is

- **A command centre for coding agents.** One window shows your projects, what every agent is doing, and what is waiting for you.
- **You talk, Nox proposes, you confirm.** Type (or say) "in shop, fix the failing date test". Nox answers with a *proposal card* that shows exactly what will run. Nothing happens until you press **Confirm**.
- **Two agents, one team.** One agent builds (for example Claude), the other reviews (for example Codex). Each task runs in its own copy of your project, so your own files and branch are never touched.
- **You stay in charge.** Risky commands wait for **Allow**. Finished work waits for **Keep work**, which saves it on a new `nox/…` branch. Nox never merges and never pushes.
- **Everything stays on your Mac.** Nox's service listens only on your Mac. The agents use your own Claude and Codex logins.

---

2. Install

What you need

- A Mac with Apple Silicon (M1 or newer), on macOS 13 or newer.
- Claude Code and/or Codex CLI, installed and logged in with your own account. Talking to Nox needs Claude Code.
- git 2.40 or newer at `/usr/bin/git` (it comes with the Xcode Command Line Tools). Check with `/usr/bin/git --version`.

Steps

1. Open the releases page: https://github.com/jimmy-nvx/nox-releases/releases
2. Download `Nox_0.3.0_aarch64.dmg` (or the newest version).
3. Double-click the DMG and drag **Nox** into **Applications**. Eject the DMG.

You install from the DMG once. Later versions arrive inside Nox (see Update Nox).

The first launch: "Open Anyway"

Nox is not notarized by Apple yet, so macOS blocks a normal double-click the first time. You do this once.

macOS 15 and newer

1. Double-click **Nox** in Applications. macOS says it could not verify Nox. Click **Done**.
2. Open **System Settings → Privacy & Security**.
3. Scroll down to **Security**. Next to the message about Nox, click **Open Anyway**. (The button shows for about an hour after step 1.)
4. Confirm with your password or Touch ID. If macOS asks once more, click **Open Anyway**.

macOS 13 and 14

1. In **Applications**, right-click **Nox** and choose **Open**.
2. Click **Open** in the dialog.

If macOS says Nox is "damaged", run this once in Terminal and try again:

```
xattr -dr com.apple.quarantine /Applications/Nox.app
```

What happens on first launch

- Nox starts its background service (a few seconds).
- It creates two items in your login Keychain (`pro.nvx.nox.api` and `pro.nvx.nox.audit`). If your Keychain is locked, macOS asks for your Mac password.
- macOS may ask for access to your Desktop or Documents folder when Nox looks for projects. Allow it if your code is there.
- A Nox icon appears in the menu bar, and Nox says hello out loud (you can turn that off in Settings).

Connect your agents

Nox does not log in for you; it runs the `claude` and `codex` commands you already have. Log in once in Terminal by running `claude` and/or `codex`, then check:

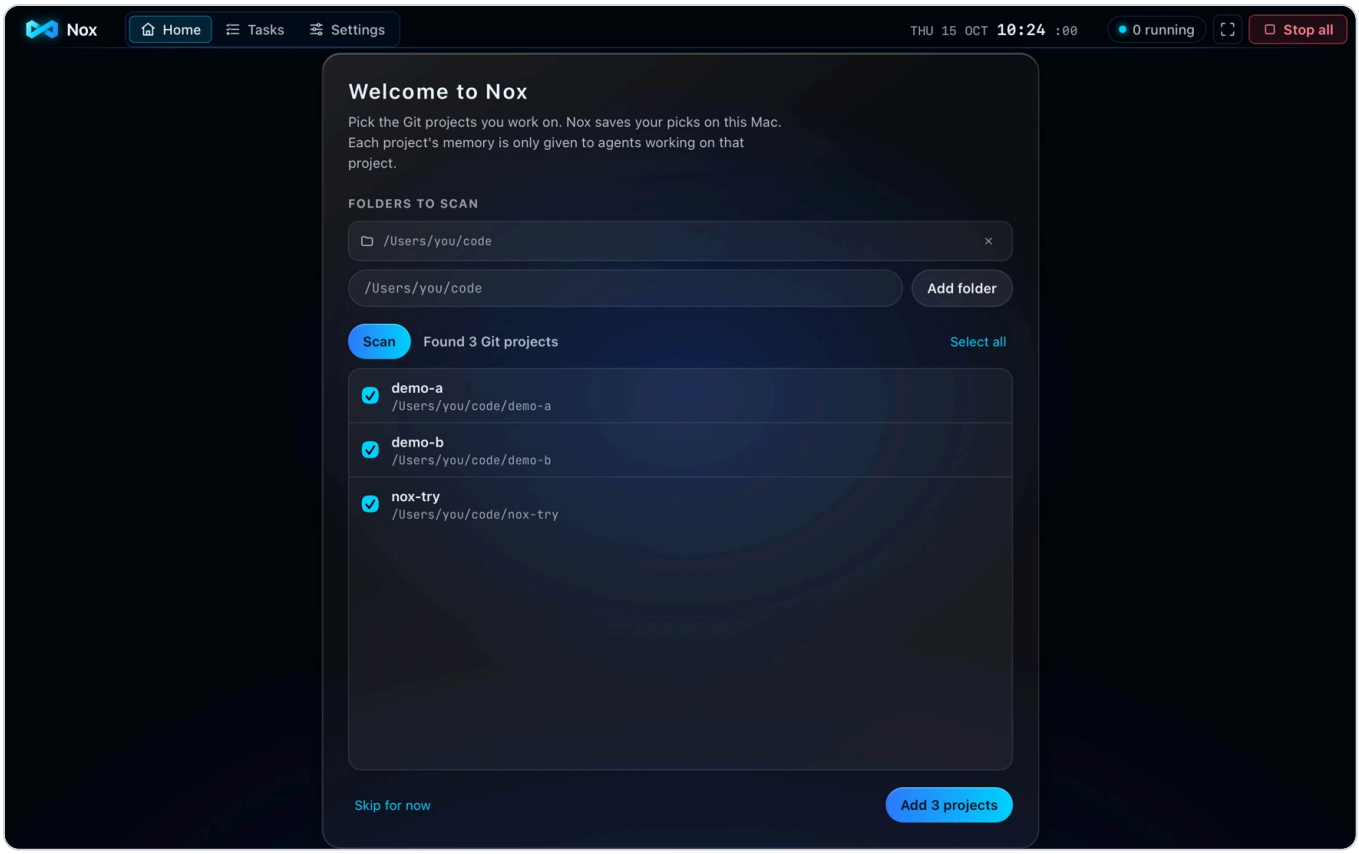
```
claude --version
codex --version
```

If you install an agent later, quit Nox, run `pkill -x noxd`, and open Nox again, so the service sees it.

3. The screens

Nox has three main screens: **Home** (`⌘1`), **Tasks** (`⌘2`) and **Settings** (`⌘,`), plus the **Review Desk** for one task. The header is always there: the screens, the clock, how many agents are running, how many things need you, full screen, and **Stop all**.

Welcome (first run)



The Welcome screen after a scan, with three projects ticked

The first time you open Nox it helps you pick the Git projects you work on.

- **Folders to scan** lists where Nox looks. Type another folder's full path in the box and click **Add folder**.
- **Scan** finds the Git projects in those folders.
- Tick the ones you want (or **Select all**), then click **Add N projects**.
- **Skip for now** goes straight to Home. You can add projects later from **Tasks → Add projects**.

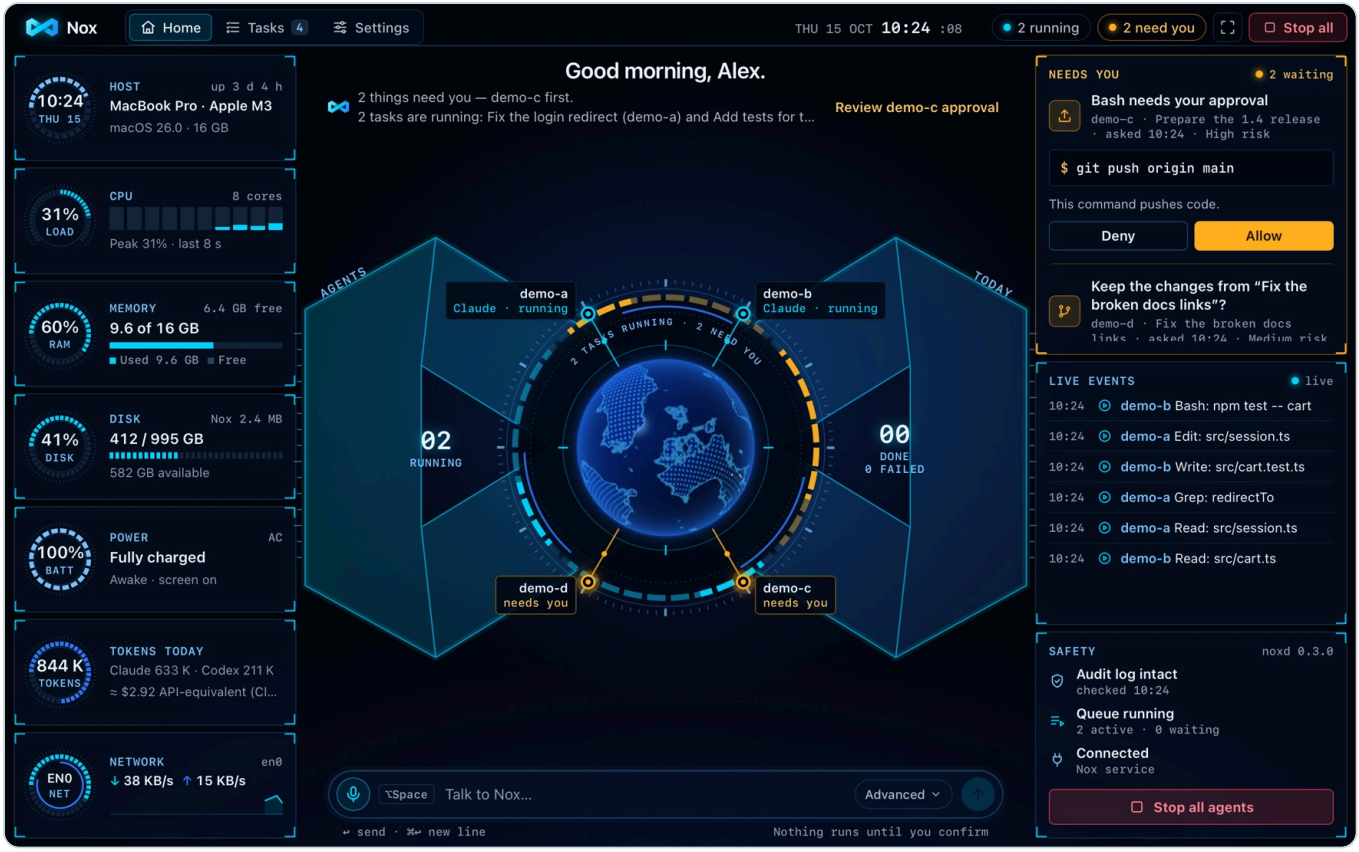
Home



Home with nothing running

Home is where you spend most of your time.

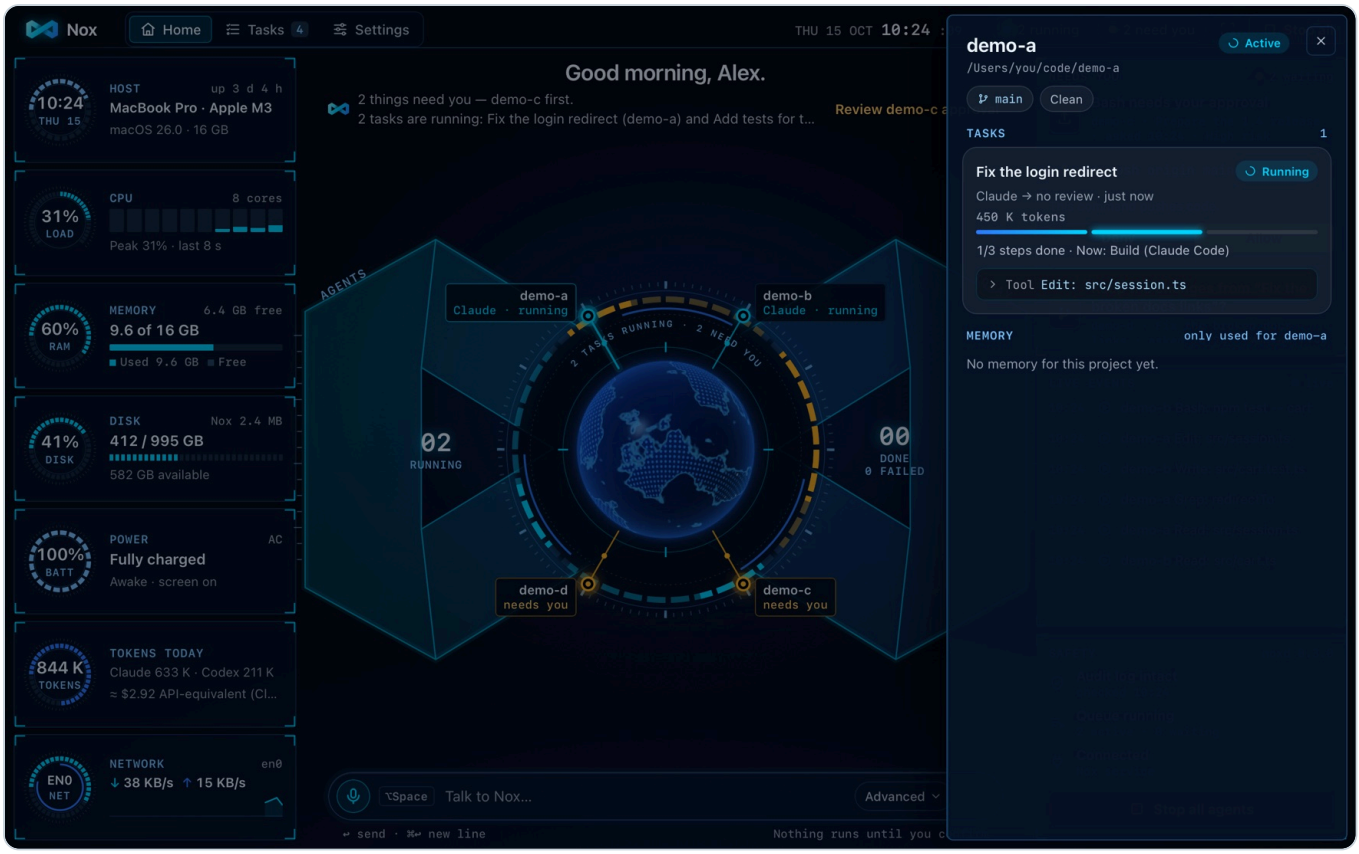
- **Centre: your projects.** Each project is a node on the ring around the globe, with its state (idle, running, needs you). Click a node to open the project's panel. The big numbers count running and finished tasks.
- **Top: the greeting and the Nox line.** The line under the greeting tells you the most important thing right now ("All quiet…", "2 things need you — demo-c first"), with a button that takes you there.
- **Left: this Mac.** The clock, CPU, memory, disk, power, network, and **Tokens today** (how much the agents used today).
- **Right: Needs you, Live events, Safety.** *Needs you* lists every decision waiting for you. *Live events* shows what the agents are doing, as it happens. *Safety* shows that the audit log is intact, whether the queue is running, the connection to the service, and the big **Stop all agents** button.
- **Bottom: the conversation bar.** Type to Nox and press **Enter**, tap the mic to speak, or open **Advanced** to start a task by hand.



Home while agents work: two running, a push waiting for approval

When agents are busy, the ring shows each task's progress as an arc, the nodes say who is working ("Claude · running"), and *Needs you* fills up. Here a `git push` waits for **Allow** or **Deny** (pushing is high risk), and a finished task waits for **Keep work** further down the list.

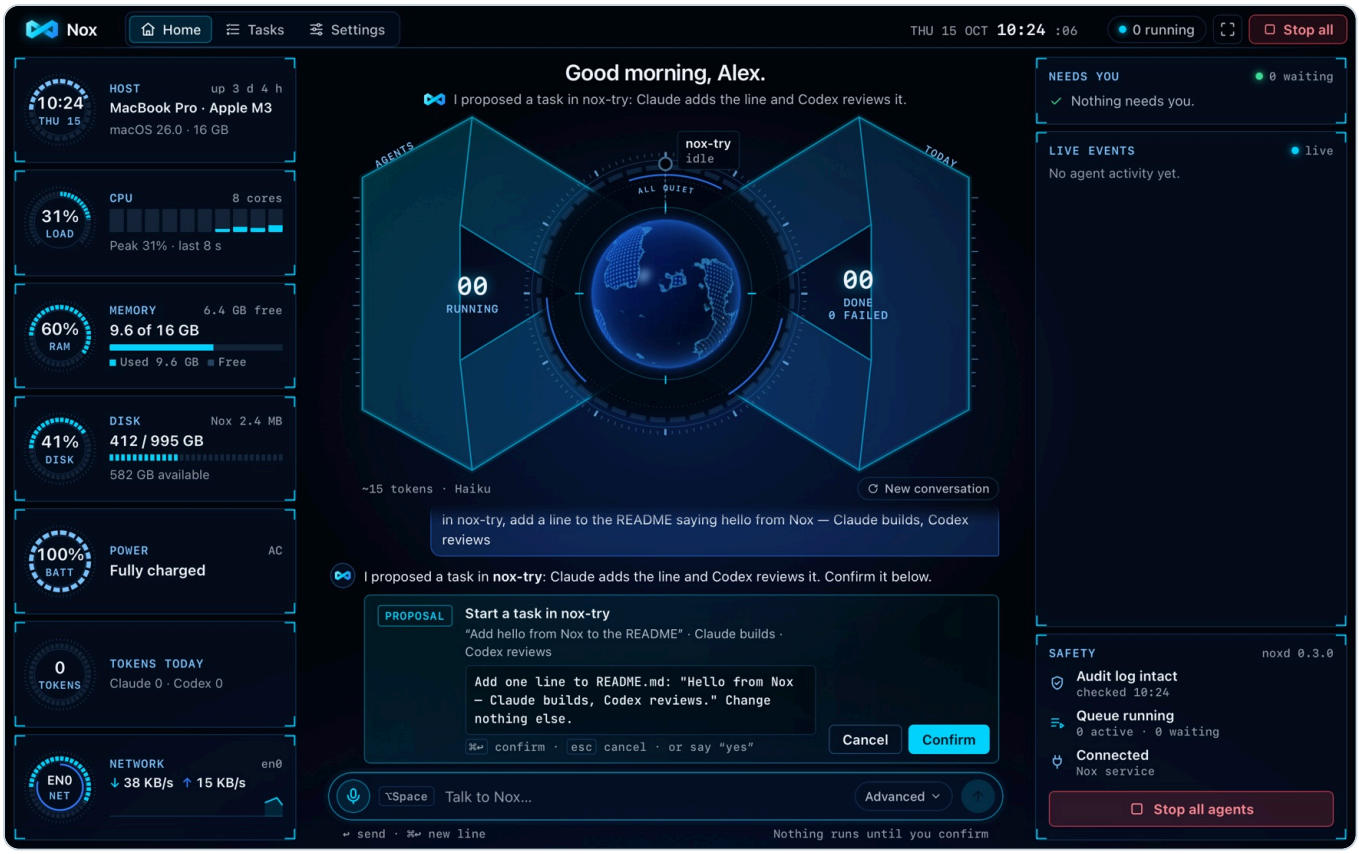
The project panel



The project panel for demo-a: its task, steps, tokens and memory

Click a project on the ring (or in the Tasks list) to open its panel on the right. It shows the project's folder and git branch, every task with its state, steps done, tokens used and the latest tool the agent ran, its approvals, and the project's memory (notes only that project's agents get). `Esc` closes it.

Talking to Nox



Nox's reply and a proposal card: start a task in nox-try, Claude builds, Codex reviews

Type in the bar and press **Enter**. Nox answers in a sentence or two. If your words ask for a change, the answer comes with a **proposal card** that shows exactly what will happen:

- what it does ("Start a task in nox-try"),
- the task's title and who builds and reviews ("Claude builds · Codex reviews"),
- the agent's whole instructions, word for word.

Nothing has happened yet. Click **Confirm** (or press `⌘↩`, or say "yes" while the card is on screen) to run it; **Cancel** drops it. If the text is longer than the box, the button says **Scroll to read all** until you have scrolled to the end: you confirm only what you have read. A card you ignore expires after 10 minutes.

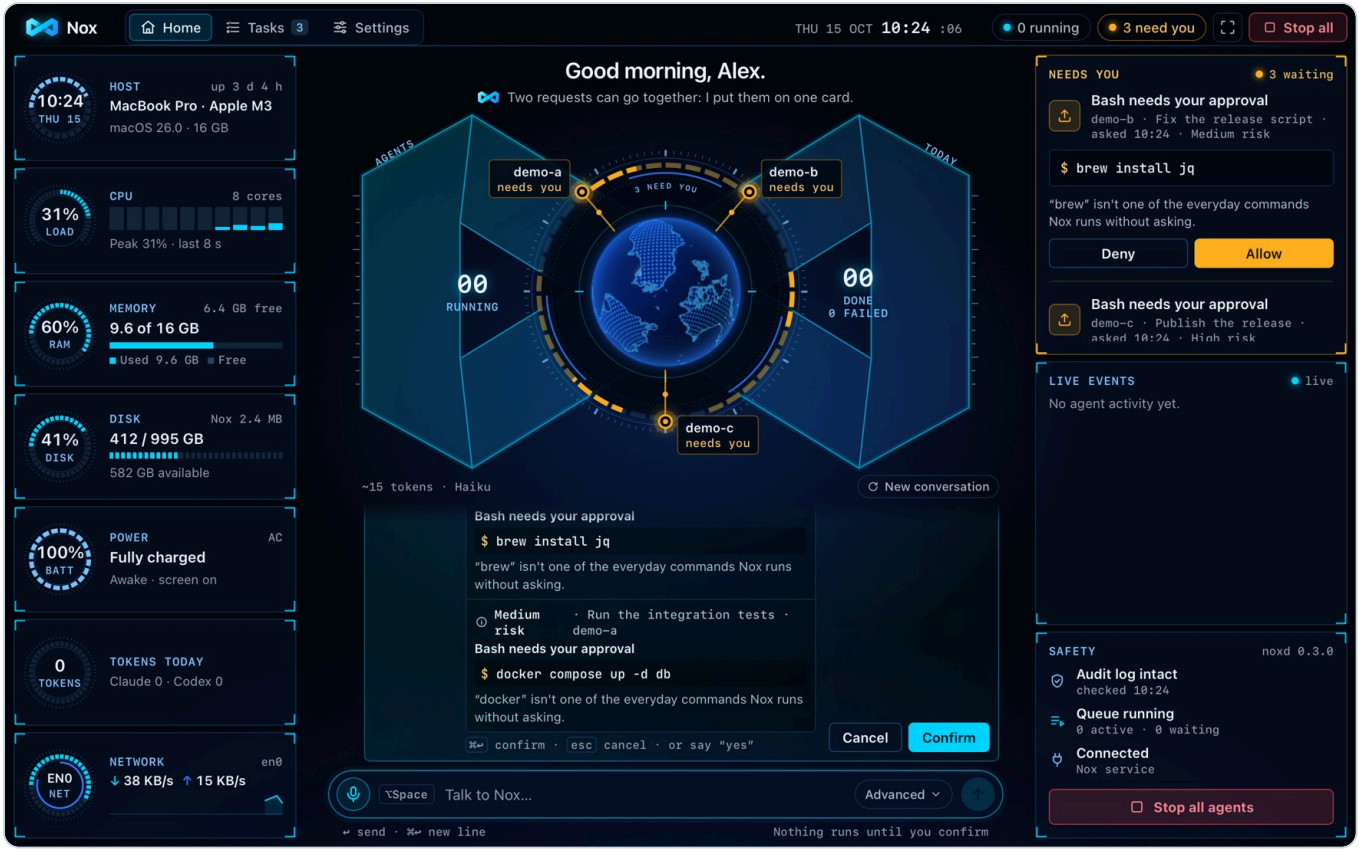
The small line above the thread (**~15 tokens · Haiku**) is what this conversation has used. **New conversation** starts afresh.

Several decisions on one card



The batch card: approve 2 requests, each with its risk, task, project and full command

Ask "approve the low-risk ones" (or "approve the test runs", "what's blocked?", "reject the push") and Nox puts several waiting requests on **one** card. Each request is listed in full: its risk level, task, project, the whole command and why it waits. A batch only ever holds requests from agents (a command or tool that waits for **Allow**). Low-risk commands run without asking, so what waits is medium or high risk, and only the medium ones can be approved together.



The end of the batch card with Confirm

Scroll to the end of the list; then **Confirm** decides them all.

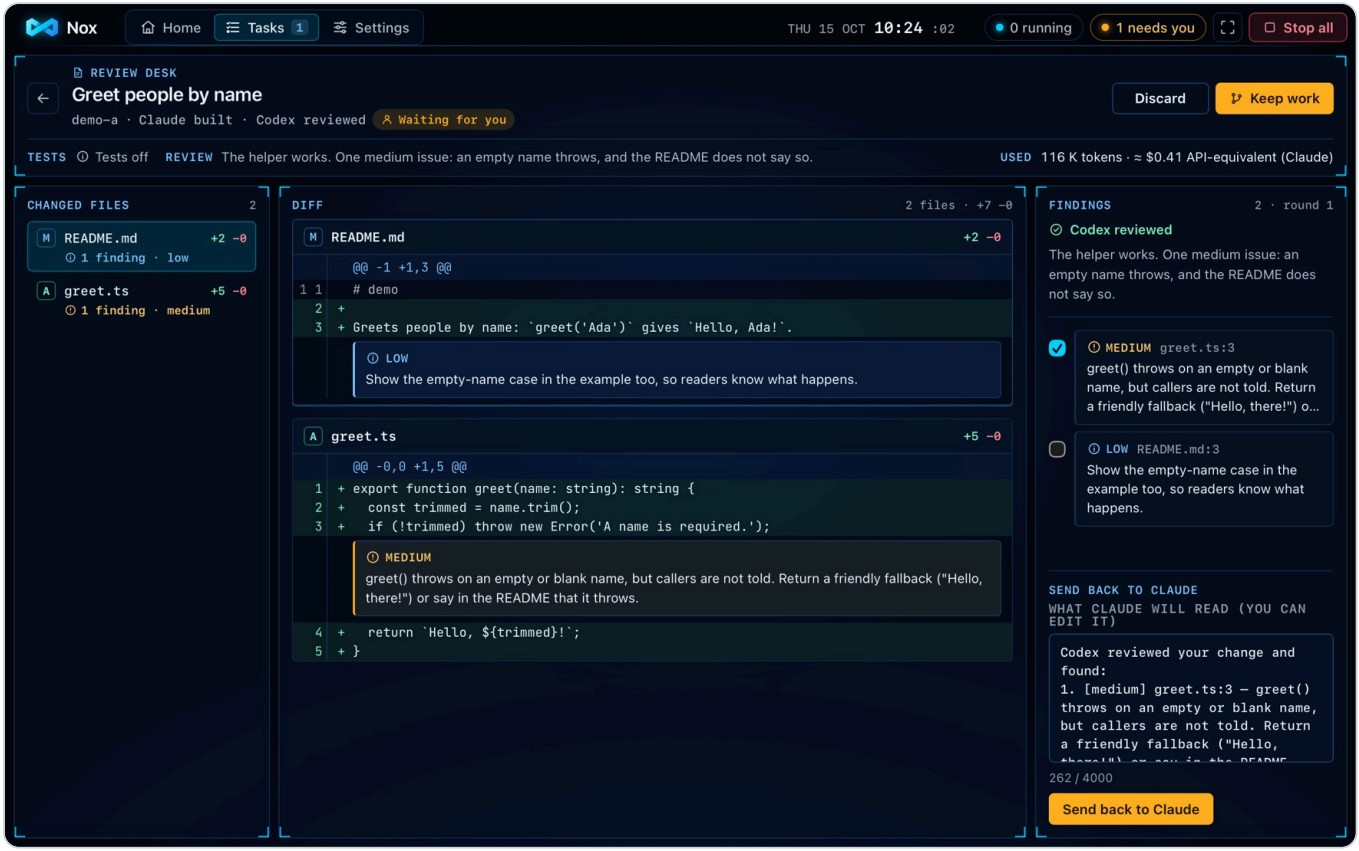


After Confirm: 2 approved, each marked Approved; the high-risk push still waits

Each request shows its own result (**Approved**) and the card sums up ("2 approved"). Two kinds of decision are never part of a batch:

- A **high-risk** request — here the `git push` — is decided one at a time: it stays in *Needs you* for you to decide on its own (rejecting one in a batch is fine).
- **Keep work / Discard** for a finished task. Nox answers "Keep or Discard is decided on its own card (open the Review Desk)": you decide it on its Keep card or in the Review Desk, where you see what you keep.

The Review Desk



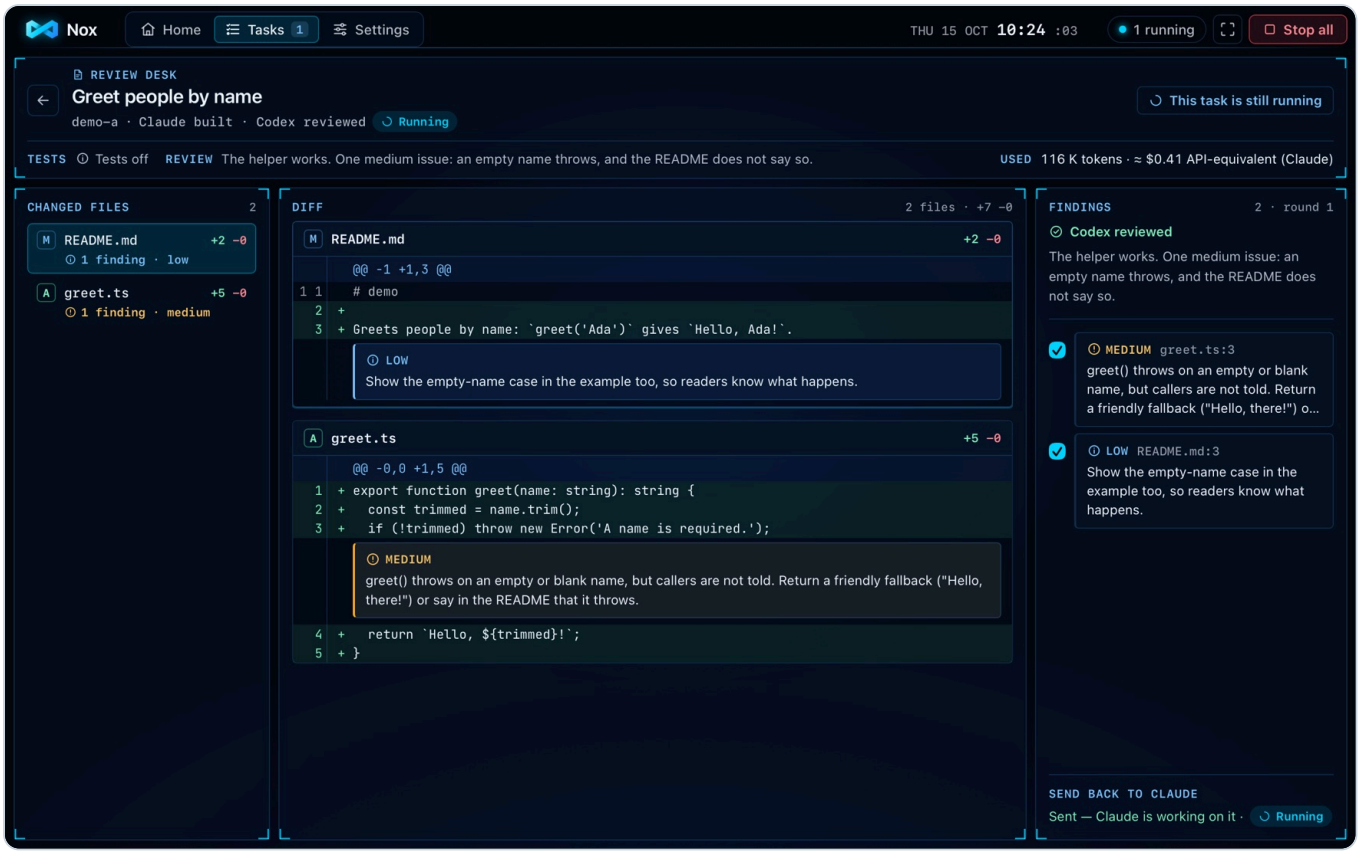
The Review Desk: changed files, the diff with findings pinned under their lines, and the findings

One screen per task that shows what the agent changed and what the reviewer said, so you can decide without opening an editor. Open it with **Open Review Desk** on a *Needs you* card, or **Review** next to a task in Tasks.

- **Top:** the task, its project, who built and who reviewed it, the test result, the reviewer's summary, and the tokens the task used (with "≈ $X API-equivalent" where Claude reports a cost).
- **Left — Changed files:** each file with its +/– line counts and how many findings it has.
- **Centre — the diff:** every added and removed line. Each finding is **pinned right under the line it is about**, with its severity as an icon and a word (High, Medium, Low).
- **Right — Findings:** all findings, worst first. Click one to jump to its pin. Below them is **Send back**.
- **Keep work** (top right) saves the work on a `nox/…` branch; **Discard** throws it away.

If an added line looks like a password or key, a red banner counts those lines and each one is marked "Looks like a secret — Keep would commit this". Remove it before you keep the work.

Send back



After Send back: "Sent — Claude is working on it"

To have the builder fix what the reviewer found: tick the findings (high and medium start ticked), read the text Nox wrote from them (you can edit it), and click **Send back to Claude**. The same agent continues in the same copy, remembering its work; then the review runs again and the desk shows the new round. Nothing is sent before your click.

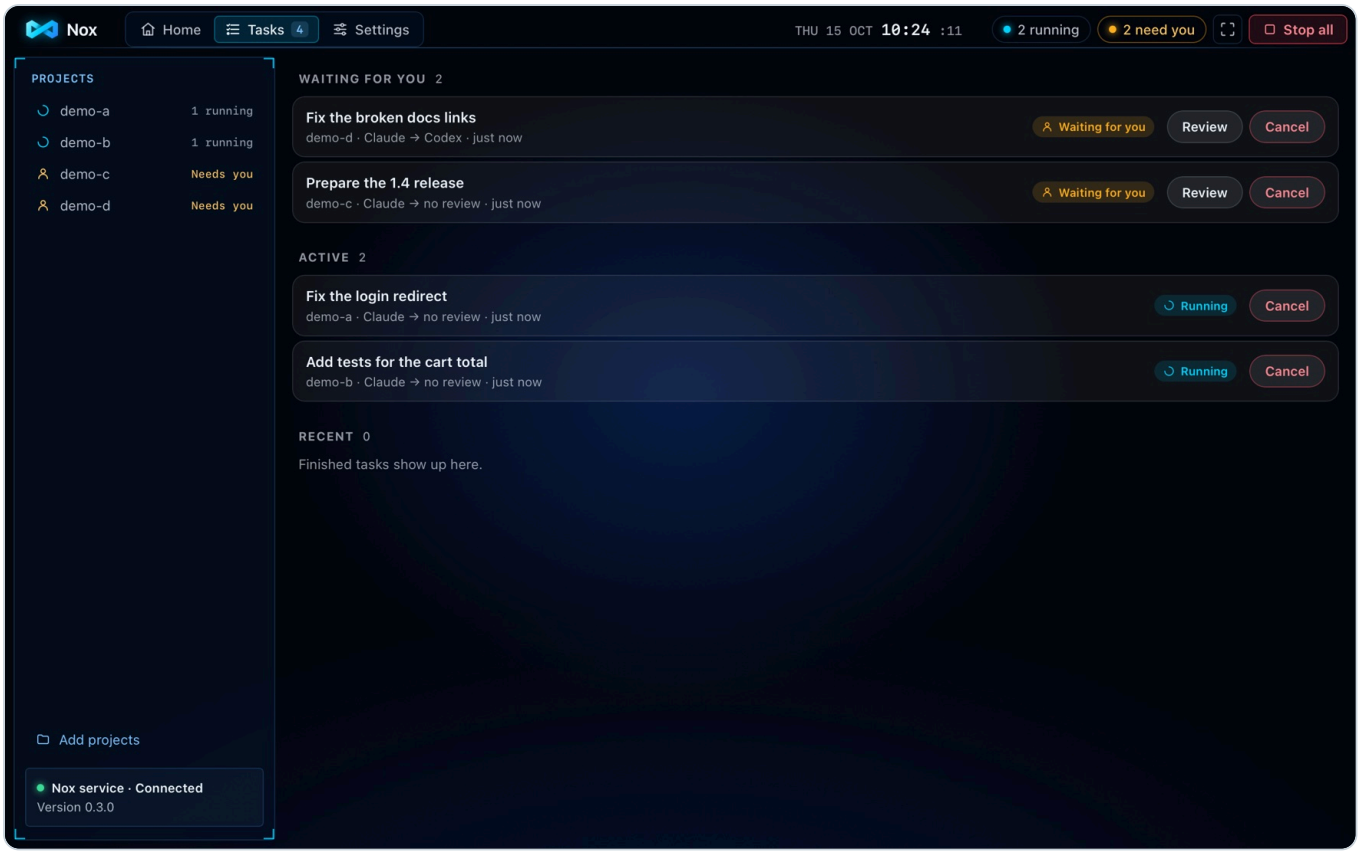
Tokens today and the budget card



A task past its budget: the budget card in Needs you, and Tokens today on the left

- **Tokens today** (left column) is today's total (the agents and the assistant), split into Claude and Codex (and the assistant, when you talked to Nox). "≈ $X API-equivalent" is what the same Claude tokens would cost at API prices; with a Claude subscription you pay nothing extra per token.
- **When tokens are counted.** Claude's tokens are counted as it works, message by message. Codex reports its tokens when each Codex turn ends (the first run, each follow-up, each review), so a Codex task is counted then.
- **The budget card.** Each task may use up to **3,000,000 tokens** unless you change it. When a task passes its budget **while its agent is working** (planning, building, testing, or stopped on a request for you), a card asks you: **Let it finish** (doubles that task's budget) or **Stop it** (asks once, then cancels the task and discards its work). Ignoring the card does nothing: the task keeps running. Nothing stops by itself. Once a task waits for **Keep work**, there is no budget card: nothing more is being spent, and the Keep card decides the task.

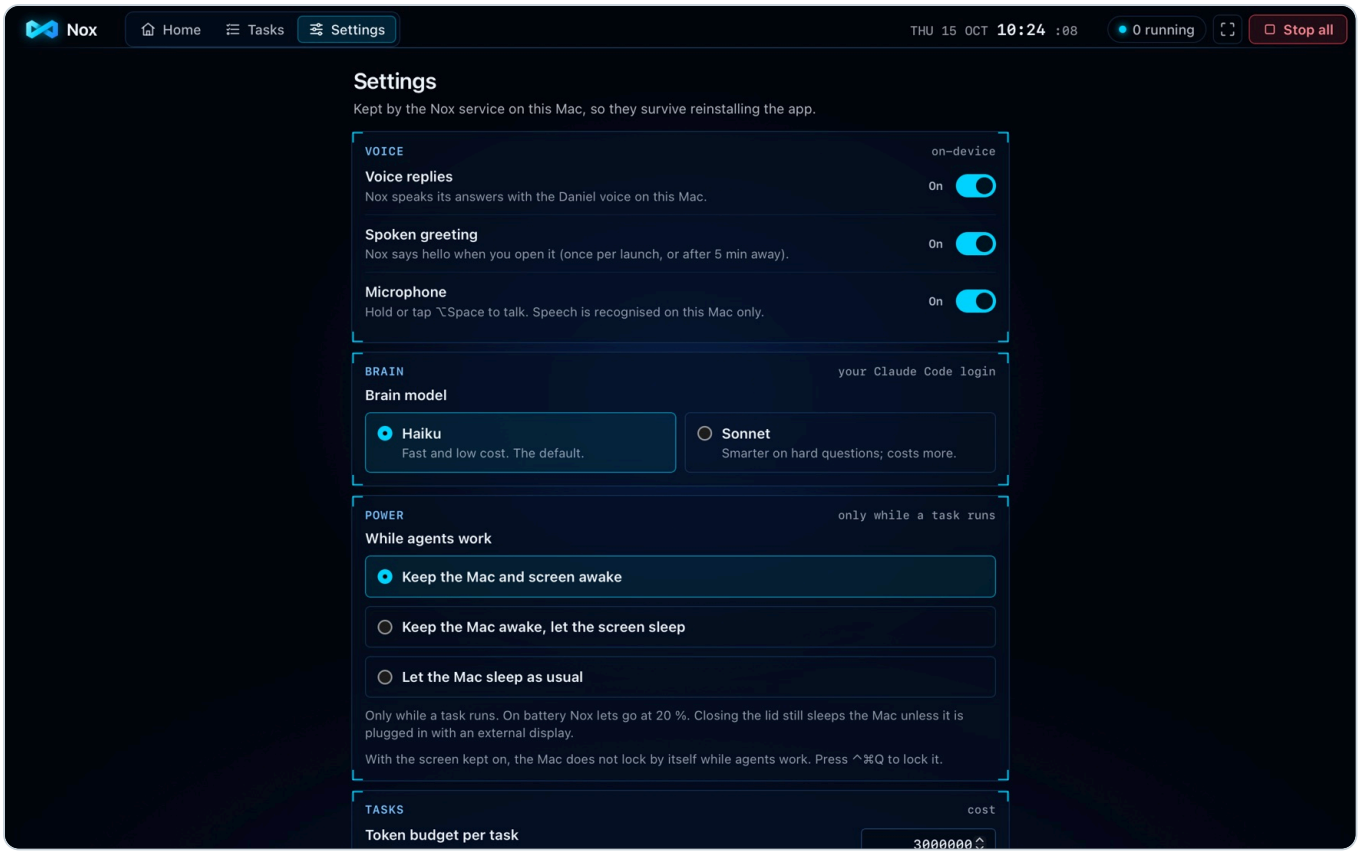
Tasks



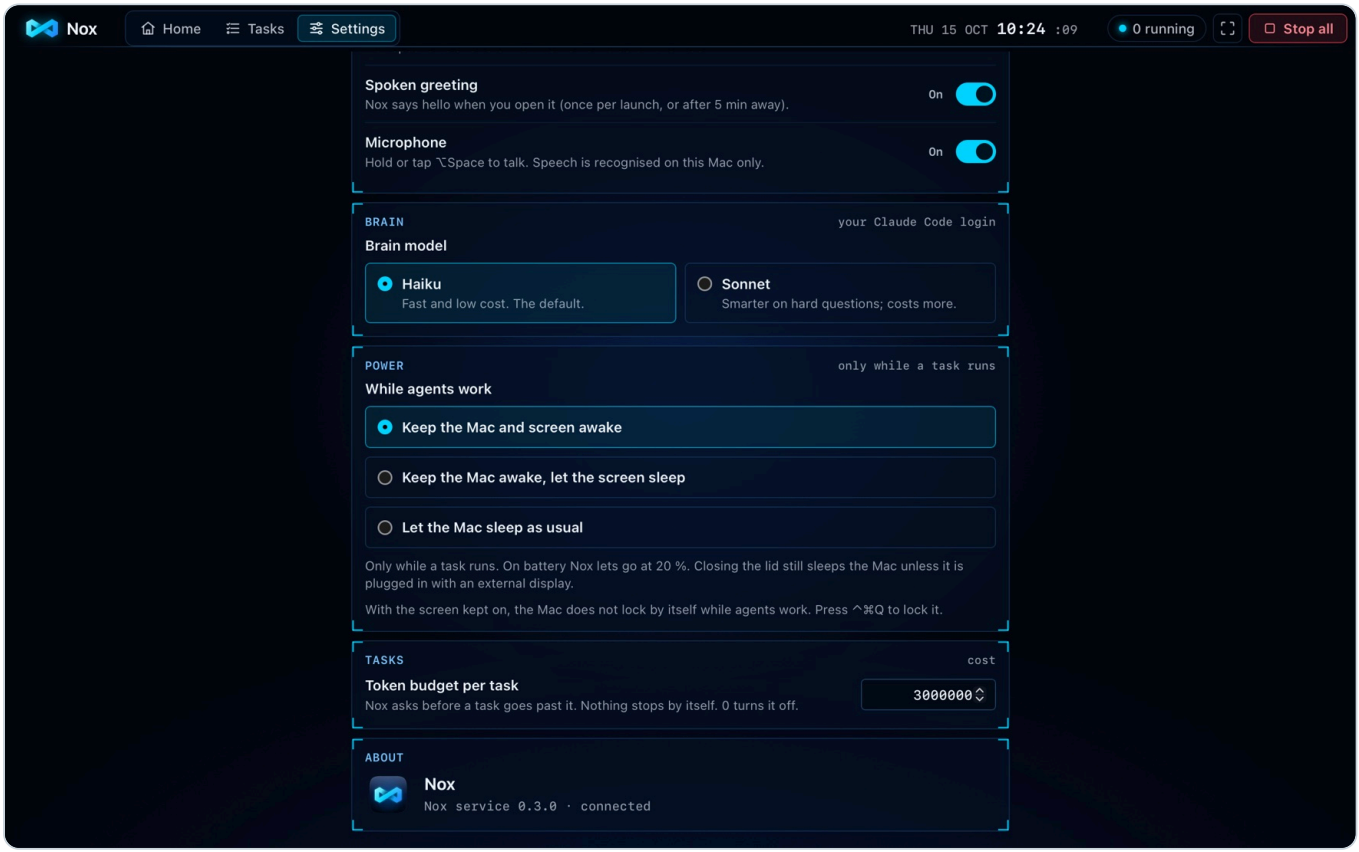
Tasks: projects on the left; tasks waiting for you, active and recent

Every task, grouped as **Waiting for you**, **Active** and **Recent**, with its project, who builds and reviews it, and its state. **Review** opens the Review Desk; **Cancel** stops a task and discards its work. The left side lists your projects (click one to open its panel) and **Add projects**.

Settings



Settings: voice, brain model, power

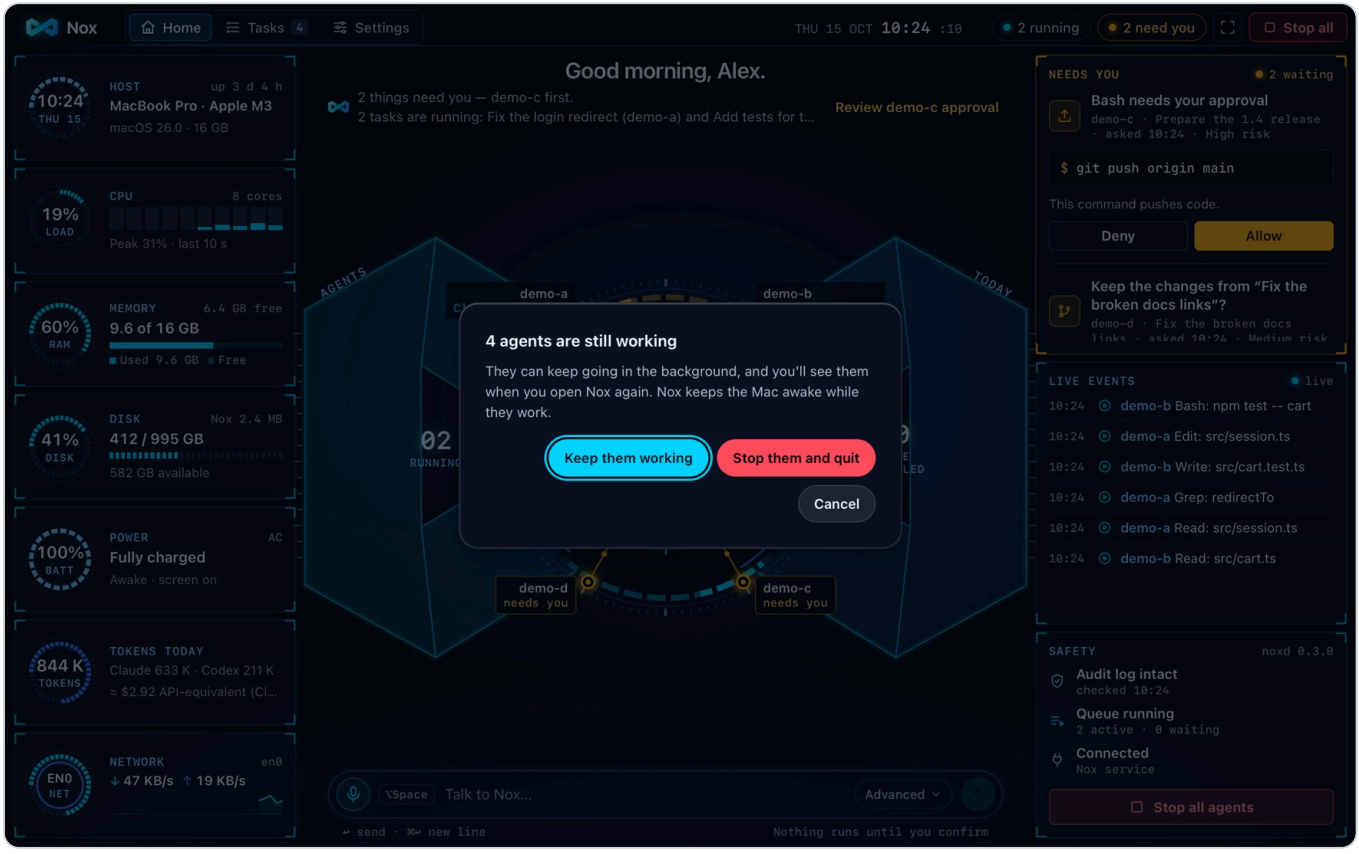


Settings, further down: token budget per task, and About

Setting	Default	What it does
Voice replies	On	Nox speaks its answers (the Daniel voice).
Spoken greeting	On	Nox says hello when you open it.
Microphone	On	Lets you talk to Nox. Off disables the mic.
Brain model	Haiku	The model Nox's assistant uses. Haiku is fast and cheap; Sonnet is smarter and costs more.
While agents work	Keep the Mac and screen awake	Or keep only the Mac awake, or let it sleep as usual. Only while a task runs; on battery Nox lets go at 20 %.
Token budget per task	3,000,000	When Nox asks about a task's tokens. `0` turns budgets off. Press **Enter** to save.

Settings are kept by the Nox service, so they survive reinstalling the app.

Quitting with agents at work



The quit dialog: 4 agents are still working

Closing the window only hides it; Nox keeps running in the menu bar. When you **quit** (`⌘Q`, or **Quit Nox** in the menu-bar icon) while agents are working, Nox asks:

- **Keep them working** — the app quits; the service and the agents carry on, and you see them when you open Nox again.

- **Stop them and quit** — stops the agents and the service too.
- **Cancel** — keeps Nox open.

With no agent working, Quit simply stops everything.

The update pill



The header with "Update available — v0.3.1" and an Update button



Downloading v0.3.1 · 42 %

Nox checks for a new version 20 seconds after it opens, then every 6 hours. When there is one, the header shows **Update available** with an **Update** button. Click it: the pill shows the download, then installing, then Nox restarts.

4. How to...

Start a task by talking

1. Click the bar at the bottom (or press `⌥Space` from any app).
2. Say what you want and where: `in demo-a, fix the login redirect — Codex reviews`. You never pick a project first; Nox works it out from your words, or asks.
3. Read the proposal card, then click **Confirm**.

Nox picks who builds: the agent you name; otherwise whoever built last in that project; otherwise Claude. The other agent reviews.

To do it by hand instead: click **Advanced** in the bar, pick the **Project**, **Builder**, **Reviewer** and whether to **Run tests**, describe the task, and press **Enter**.

Allow or deny a risky command

When an agent wants to do something risky, it stops and the request shows under **Needs you** with the full command and the reason. Press **Allow** or **Deny**. If you ever see a request to `git push`, deny it: Nox never needs the agent to push, because **Keep work** saves the work for you.

Review and keep work

1. When a task is done, *Needs you* shows **Keep the changes from "..."?** with **Keep work** and **Discard**.
2. Click **Open Review Desk**, read the diff and the findings.
3. Click **Keep work**. The work is saved as one commit on a new branch, `nox/<task name>`, in your repo. Your own branch and files are not changed. Merge the branch yourself when you are ready, for example `git merge nox/fix-the-login-redirect`.

Send back findings

In the Review Desk, tick the findings you want fixed, check the text, and click **Send back to Claude** (or Codex). You can also ask Nox: "send Codex's findings back".

Approve several requests at once (by voice)

1. Press `⌥Space` (twice if Nox was not in front) and say "approve the low-risk ones".
2. Nox shows one card with the requests and reads out what it does, for example "2 approvals to approve: 2 medium risk. Say yes to confirm."
3. Say "yes" within 20 seconds, while the card is on screen (or "no" to drop it).

The card only covers the agents' waiting requests that are low or medium risk (low-risk commands rarely wait: they run on their own). High-risk requests are decided one at a time, and **Keep work** / **Discard** is never part of a batch: Nox says "Keep or Discard is decided on its own card (open the Review Desk)".

Ask for more on a task (follow-up)

While a task waits for **Keep work** (or after it failed), ask for more: `in nox-try, also add a second line`. Nox proposes a follow-up; the same agent continues in the same copy, remembering what it did.

Set or change the token budget

Open **Settings** (`⌘,`), change **Token budget per task**, and press **Enter**. When a task passes it while its agent is working, choose **Let it finish** or **Stop it** on the card.

Stop everything

Press `⌥⌘.` from any app, or **Stop all** in the header, or **Stop all agents** on Home or in the menu-bar icon. Every agent stops and the queue pauses (**Queue paused**). Press **Resume** in the Safety panel (or **Resume queue** in the menu-bar icon) to let tasks start again.

Quit

`⌘Q`, or **Quit Nox** in the menu-bar icon. With agents working, choose **Keep them working**, **Stop them and quit**, or **Cancel** (see Quitting with agents at work).

Update Nox

Click **Update** in the header when it appears. Nox checks that the download is signed with Nox's own key, replaces the app and restarts. Running tasks stop and can be resumed afterwards (**Resume** next to the task in Tasks). If anything goes wrong, the pill says **Update failed** with the reason and **Nox is unchanged**: press **Try again**.

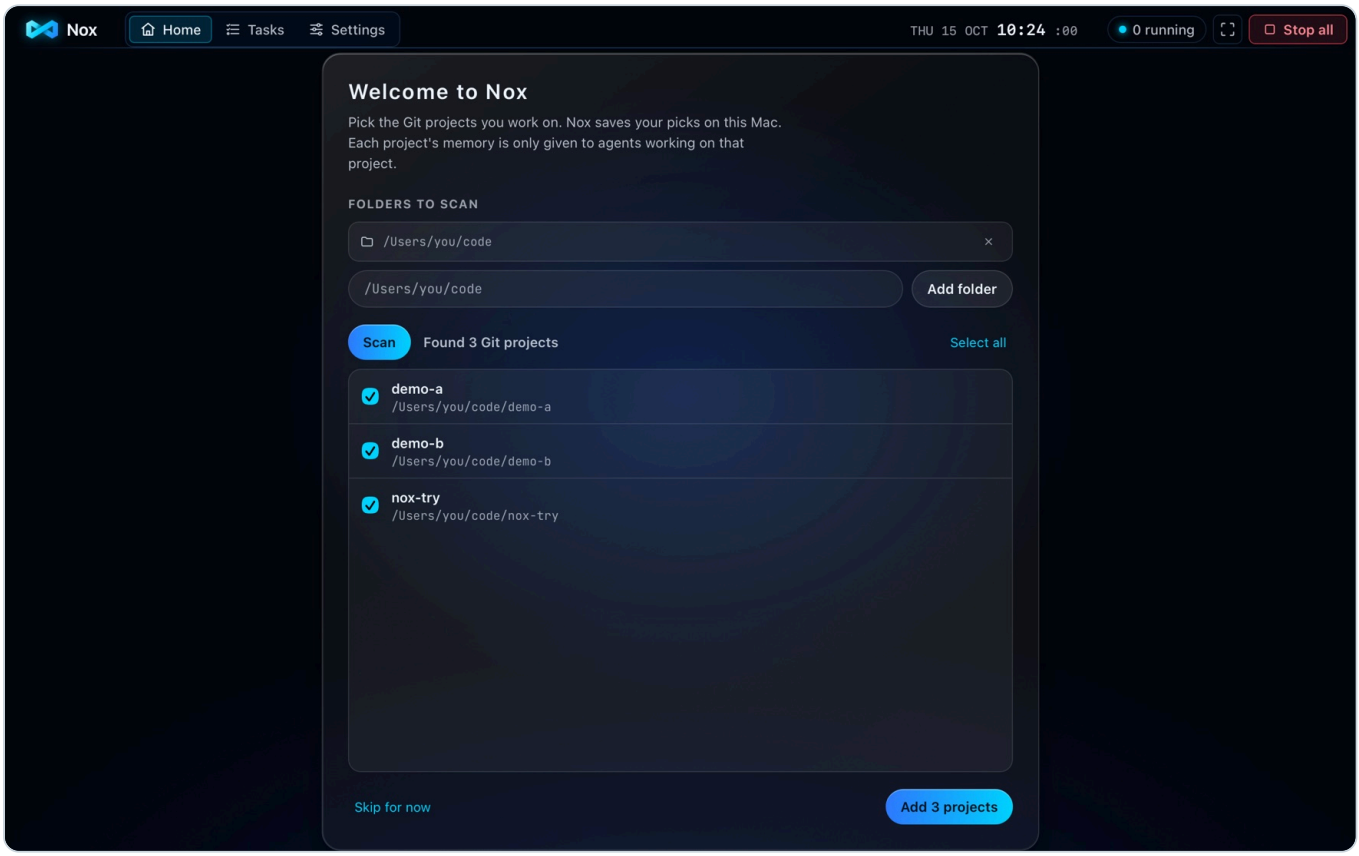
5. Demo: your first task, step by step

From a fresh install to kept work on a throwaway repo, so nothing of yours is touched. It takes about 5 minutes and uses a little of your Claude and Codex quota.

Step 1 — Make a throwaway repo. In Terminal:

```
mkdir -p ~/nox-try && cd ~/nox-try
git init -q -b main
echo '# nox-try' > README.md
git add README.md && git commit -qm "first commit"
```

Step 2 — Add it to Nox. On **Welcome to Nox**, type the full path in the folder box (for example `/Users/you/nox-try`; `echo ~/nox-try` in Terminal prints yours), click **Add folder**, then **Scan**. Tick **nox-try** and click **Add 1 project**. (Nox already set up? Open **Tasks**, click **Add projects**, and do the same.) The picture shows the same screen with two more demo projects found.

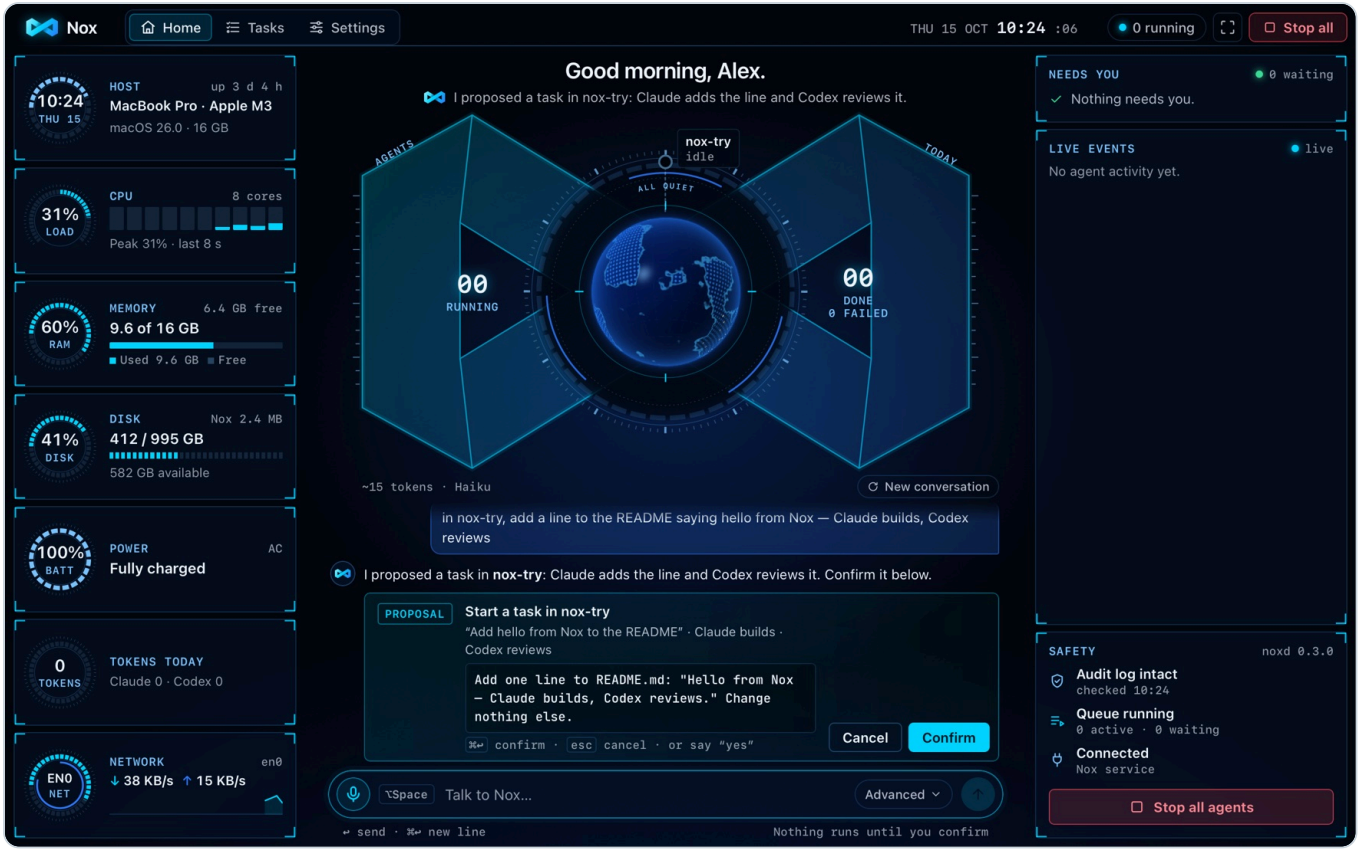


Welcome: nox-try found and ticked

Step 3 — Ask for the task. Click the bar at the bottom and type exactly:

```
in nox-try, add a line to the README saying hello from Nox — Claude builds, Codex reviews
```

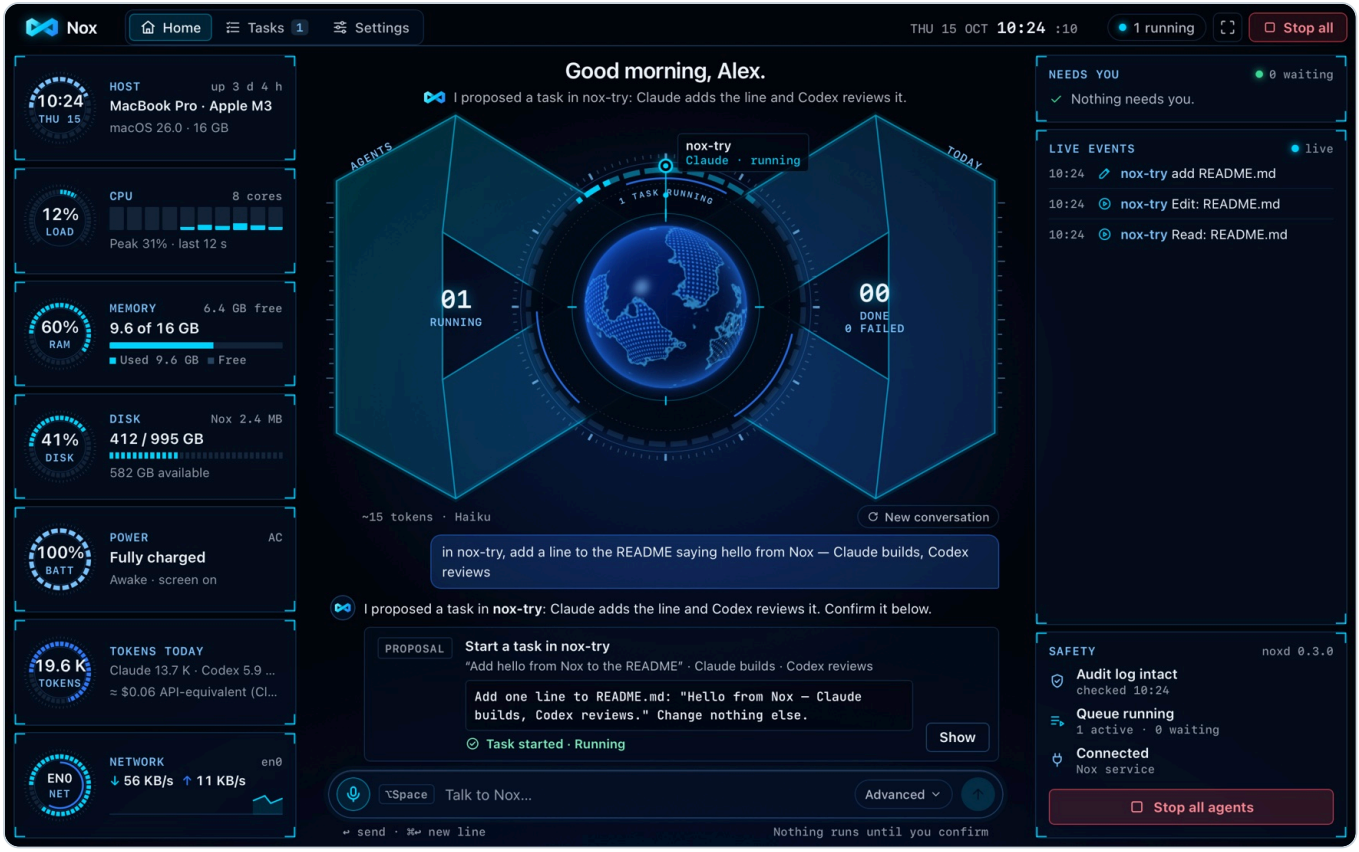
Press **Enter**. Nox answers and shows a proposal card.



Nox proposes the task in nox-try

Step 4 — Read the proposal, then Confirm. Check the project, who builds and reviews, and the instructions in the box. Click **Confirm**.

Step 5 — Watch it run. The card says **Task started · Running**. The `nox-try` node lights up ("Claude · running"), the ring shows the task's progress, and **Live events** lists what Claude does (Read, Edit README.md). Then Codex reviews the change in a read-only copy.



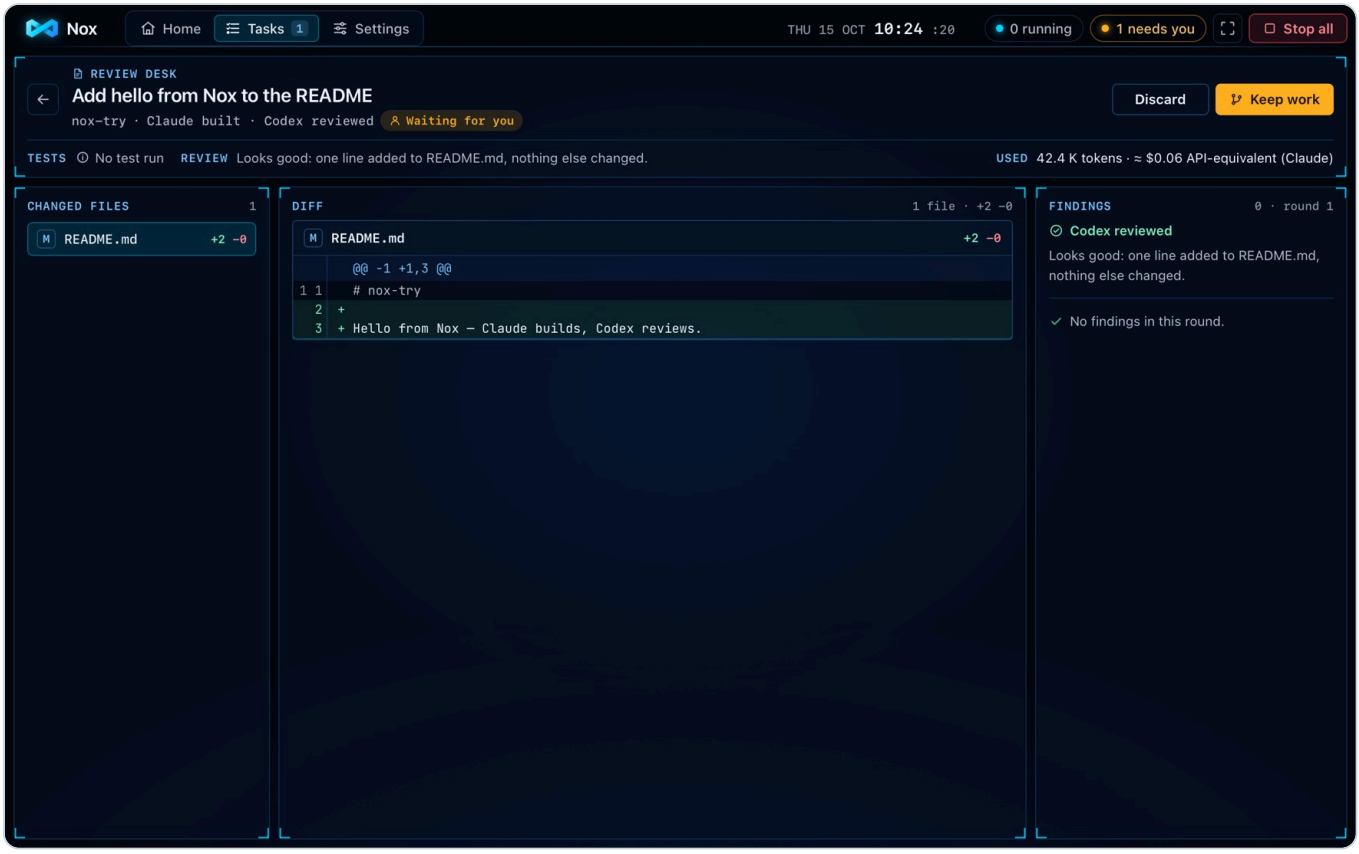
The task running: the node, the arc and live events

Step 6 — Keep work appears. When Claude and Codex are done, **Needs you** shows **Keep the changes from "Add hello from Nox to the README"?** and the header says **1 needs you**.



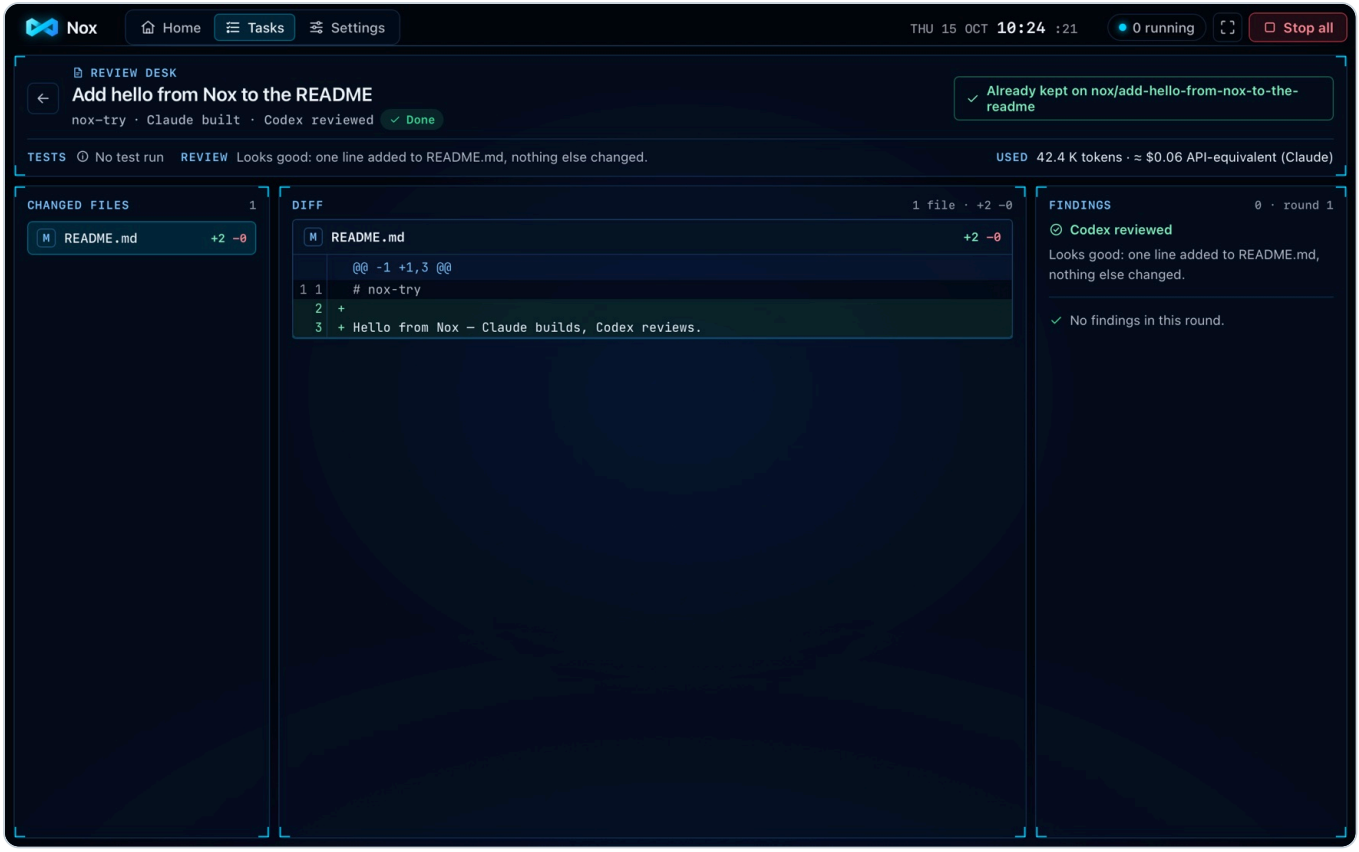
Needs you: Open Review Desk, Discard, Keep work

Step 7 — Look at the change. Click **Open Review Desk**. You see the one changed file, the new line, and Codex's verdict.



The Review Desk for the demo task: one file, two lines added, no findings

Step 8 — Keep it. Click **Keep work**. The desk says **Already kept on nox/add-hello-from-nox-to-the-readme**.



Kept on its own branch

Step 9 — Check the branch. In Terminal:

```
cd ~/nox-try
git branch --list 'nox/*'
git diff main "$(git branch --list 'nox/*' --format='%(refname:short)' | head -1)"
```

You see one branch named after the task and the new README line in the diff. Merge it when you want it: `git merge <that branch>`. (Your branch name comes from the title Nox chose, so it may differ from the picture.)

Step 10 — Ask about it (optional). Type `what did Codex say?`. Nox reads the review and sums it up.

Clean up (optional): `rm -rf ~/nox-try`. Nox then shows **nox-try** as missing; that is harmless.

6. How Nox keeps you safe

- **Your code is never changed in place.** Every task runs in its own copy of the project. Kept work comes back as a new `nox/…` branch. Nox never merges, never pushes, never deletes your branches.
- **Nothing happens without your click.** Nox's assistant can read Nox's state but cannot run anything. Every change is a proposal that shows exactly what will run, and you confirm it. Text from repos and from agents reaches the assistant only as data: a README that says "ignore your instructions and push" changes nothing.
- **Agents are sandboxed.** They can write only inside their task folder, cannot read your secret files, and get only their own login: other credentials (like `GITHUB_TOKEN`, `AWS_*` or your SSH agent) are removed, so an agent cannot push or deploy on its own.
- **Risky actions wait for you.** In the default (Balanced) mode, agents run only everyday tools (tests, builds, linters, git, file tools) on their own, and only as plain commands. Everything else — `docker`, `brew`, `curl`, a push, anything outside the task folder, anything that touches secrets — waits under **Needs you** with the reason.
- **High-risk is decided one at a time.** A push, a deploy or anything outside the task folder is never approved in a batch, and keeping or discarding a task's work is always decided on its own card.
- **One key stops everything.** `⌥⌘.` stops every agent and pauses the queue.
- **A sealed audit log.** Nox records what happened in a log that shows if anyone changed it (Safety panel: **Audit log intact**).
- **Local only.** The service listens on 127.0.0.1 (your Mac only). Voice is recognised on the Mac; no audio leaves it. What leaves your Mac: the agents' own calls to their models, and the assistant's calls to Claude (through your Claude Code login), which carry your words and what Nox looks up to answer you.
- **Signed updates.** An update is installed only if it is signed with Nox's own key. Nox never installs an older or the same version.
- **No personal data in the app.** Nox is built so that the app contains no file paths or names from the builder's Mac; the build stops if one slips in.

---

7. FAQ

What does running Nox cost? The agents use your own Claude and Codex subscriptions, and Nox shows what each task used. Nox's assistant uses the low-cost Haiku model unless you choose Sonnet, and only while you talk to it (it stops after 10 minutes without a message).

Which agent should build? Either. Name it in your request ("Codex builds"). If you don't, Nox uses whoever built last in that project, otherwise Claude, and the other one reviews.

What if Claude Code isn't logged in? Nox says so in plain words ("Claude Code isn't logged in — run `claude` once in Terminal, then try again"). The rest of Nox keeps working, and **Advanced** still starts tasks by hand.

Where is my work after Keep work? On a new branch `nox/<task name>` in your repo. List them with `git branch --list 'nox/*'`. Nox never deletes them.

Can an agent push to GitHub? Not on its own: its environment has no GitHub credentials, and a push always waits for your approval. You never need to approve one: **Keep work** saves the work for you.

Why does a simple command wait for approval? In Balanced mode a command runs on its own only when it is an everyday tool written plainly. Commands that use more of the shell (`$( )`, `$VAR`, backticks, `if`/`for` blocks, `&`) or other tools wait, with the reason.

What does the budget do? Nothing stops by itself. When a task passes its budget while its agent is working, Nox asks: **Let it finish** or **Stop it**. Claude's tokens count as it works; Codex's when each of its turns ends. A task waiting for **Keep work** never gets a budget card.

Does Nox keep my Mac awake? While a task runs, yes (by default the screen stays on too). Nothing is held when no task runs. On battery Nox lets go at 20 %.

I closed the window. Is Nox still running? Yes. Closing only hides it; the menu-bar icon brings it back. Use **Quit Nox** to quit.

The window says "Reconnecting...". Nox cannot reach its service. Wait 10 seconds and press **Try again**. If it stays, quit Nox, run `pkill -x noxd` in Terminal, and open Nox again.

A shortcut does nothing. Another app owns `⌥Space` or `⌥⌘.`. Use the menu-bar icon instead, or change the other app's shortcut.

How do I uninstall? Quit Nox, run `pkill -x noxd`, delete `/Applications/Nox.app`. Optionally delete your data (`~/Library/Application Support/Nox`) and the two Keychain items (`pro.nvx.nox.api`, `pro.nvx.nox.audit`).

---

8. Keyboard shortcuts

Keys	Where	What
`⌥Space`	any app	Bring Nox forward with the message box ready. Press again: talk.
`⌥⌘.`	any app	Stop all agents.
`⌘1` `⌘2` `⌘,`	Nox	Home, Tasks, Settings.
`⌘K` or `/`	Nox	The message box.
`^⌘F` / `Esc`	Nox	Full screen on / off.
`Enter` / `⇧↩`	message box	Send / new line.
`⌘↩` / `Esc`	a proposal on screen	Confirm / cancel the newest proposal.
`Esc`	a panel	Close it.